



THE EKANA PRESS BOX WAS ABUZZ WITH DEBATE AND THE FAVOURITE TOPIC WAS ABOUT THE NATURE OF THE PITCH



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unsuccessful run chases, this time, he was in the middle as early as the 11th over. The crowd had plenty of time to feast on their hero and for Dhoni to redeem himself, but the question that lingered in the melancholic aftermath of the match was, "How much was too much?"

Dhruva Prasad

Pitch imperfect

The Ekana press box was abuzz with debate as the Diary walked in on the eve of the IPL 2025 match between Lucknow Super Giants and Punjab Kings. The topic? A familiar one among cricket journalists — the nature of the pitch (**above**). The black-soil faction made its case early.

"I was here three days ago and had a close look. It is definitely black soil," declared one of its strongest advocates.

The Diary glanced at the pitch and thought, 'Ah, this looks like a black-soil one.'

The red-soil supporters were quick to counter. "We spoke to the curator today, and he said it's red soil."

The Diary glanced at the pitch again. 'Ah, this looks like a red-soil one.'

Observer bias is real, friends.

True to India's democratic spirit, the Diary was consulted for its opinion. "It's a mix of red and black soil," it declared — ever the

champion of the middle ground.

And true to India's democratic spirit, the Diary's opinion was swiftly ignored.

Eventually, the pre-match pitch report confirmed it was red soil. Half the press box celebrated, quietly.

The home team, which preferred black soil, was visibly unhappy. Punjab Kings dominated from start to finish, sealing an emphatic eight-wicket win.

At the post-match press conference, LSG mentor Zaheer Khan remarked that the Lucknow curator seemed to have favoured Punjab. The reporters had their headline.

Pranay Rajiv